LESSON 1

Hot Cross Buns

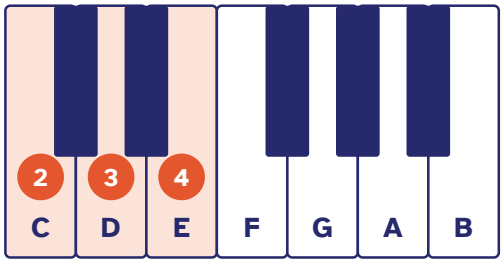
A street cry: bakers sang it in London on Good Friday to sell their spiced buns. It was written down in 1733.

IN THIS SONG **three notes: E D C** **steps down** **walk and run-ning** **fingers 4 3 2**

LISTEN FIRST
Hear the whole song before you take it apart: scan the code, listen once, then hum along the second time.

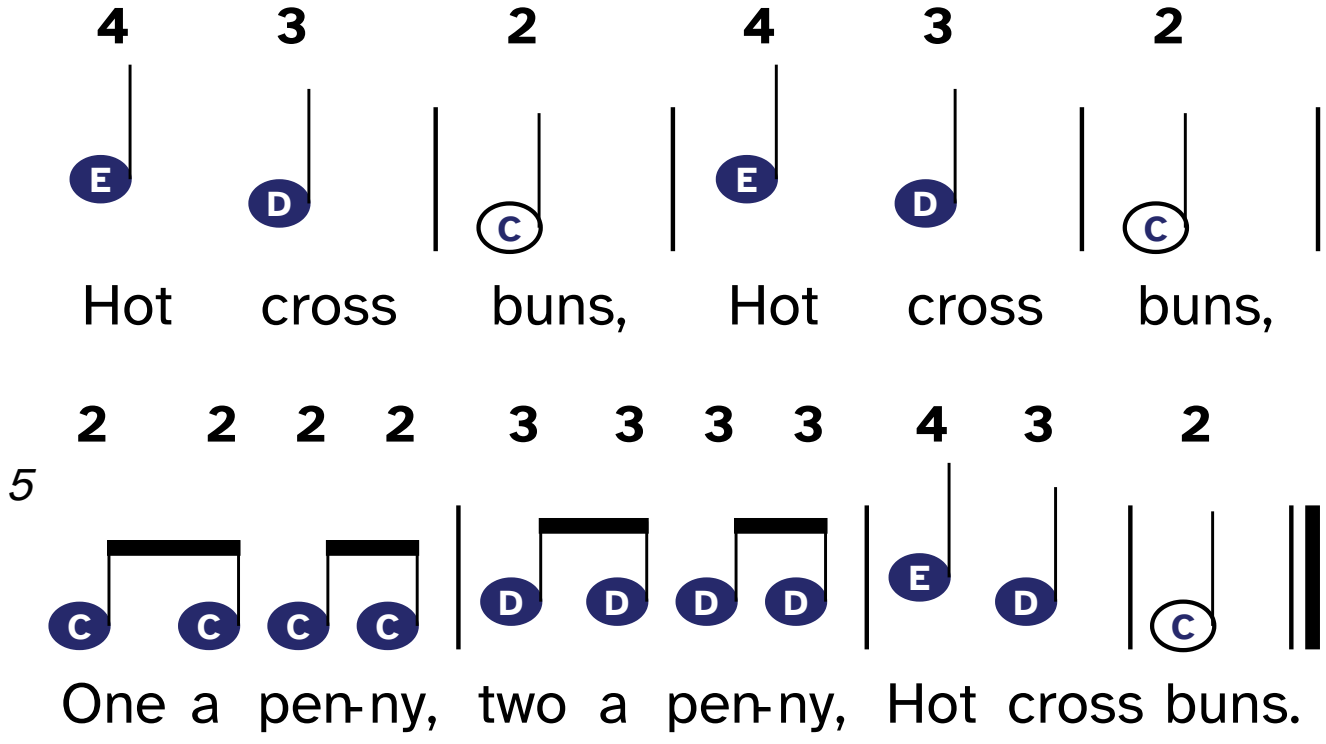
1 Listen and sing

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words, then on the letter names.



middle C

Your hand. Right hand: finger 2 on middle C, 3 on D, 4 on E. Three middle fingers, the easiest to start with.
Steps down. Each note is the next key down: E, D, C. On the page each one sits a step lower, so the tune looks the way it sounds.



- [ ] Listened and pointed
- [ ] Sang it with the words
- [ ] Sang the letter names

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE BEAT

Count 1 2 in every bar, steady as a clock: two beats a bar.
Walk on a beat; run two quick notes in one beat: say *pen-ny*, count *1 +*.

THE NOTES



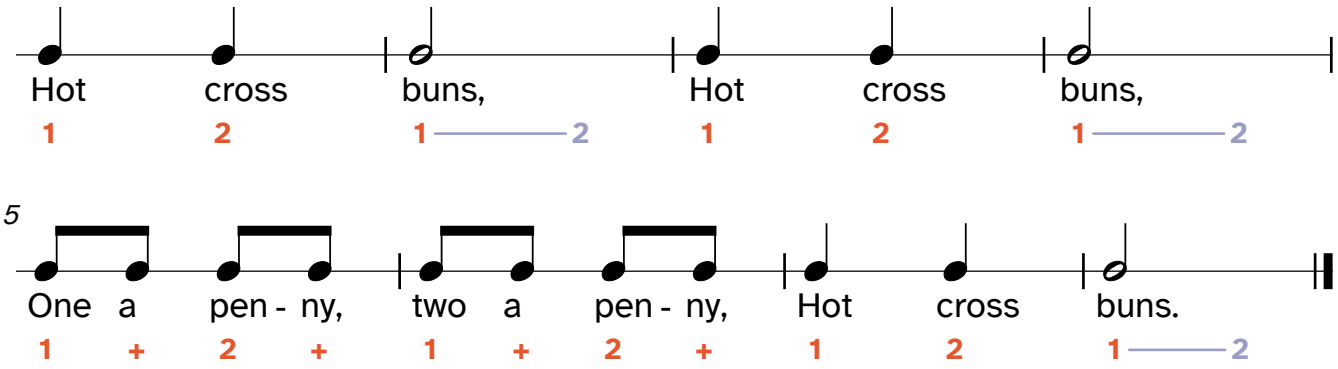
crotchet: walk
1 beat



two quavers: run-ning
1 beat

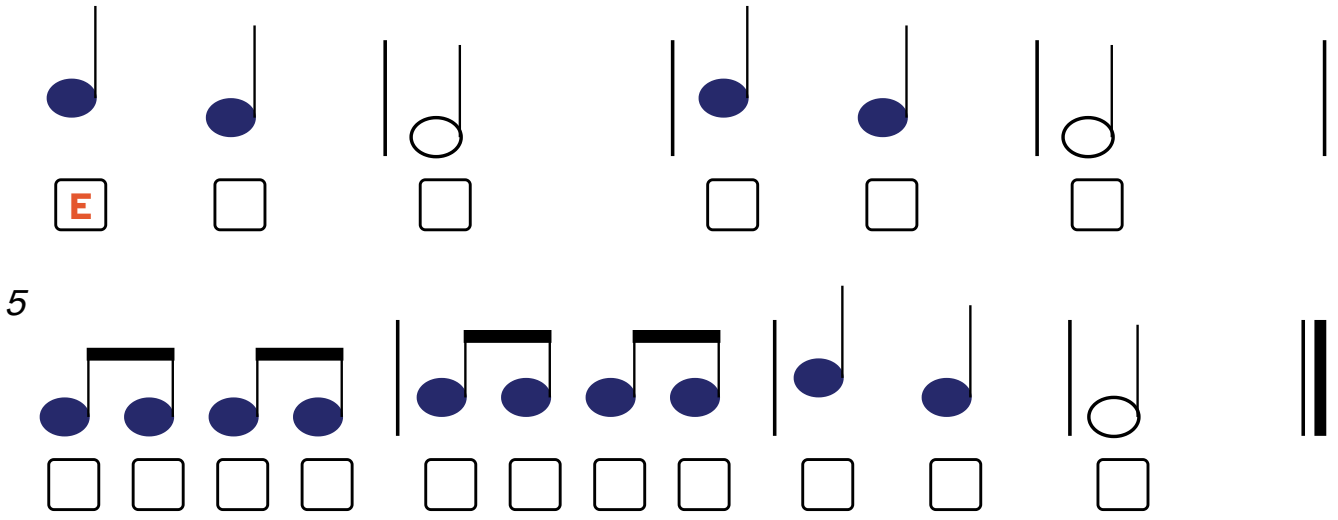


minim
2 beats



THE NOTES

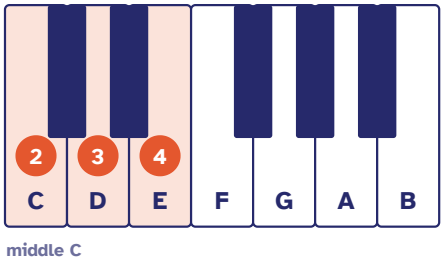
Now the notes are empty. Write E, D or C in each box, then sing it on the letter names.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Ran on "one a penny"**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**

3 Play it

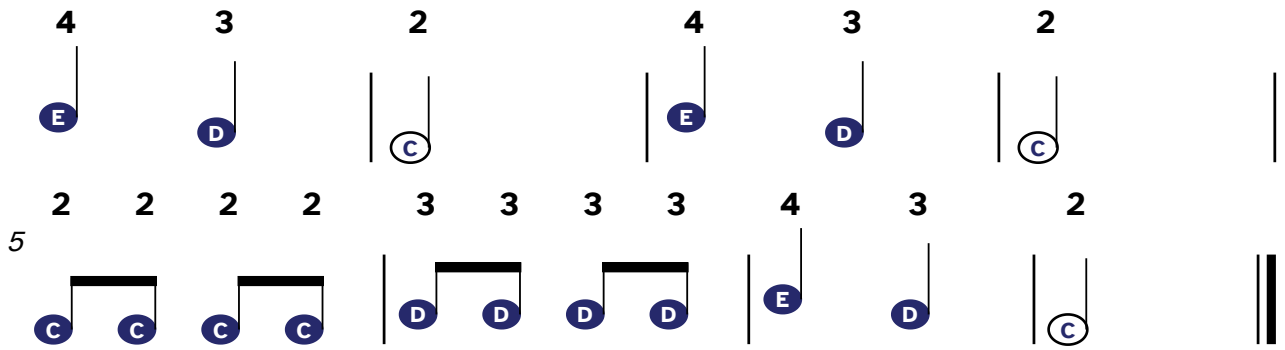
The white keys C D E, with the right hand, then the left.



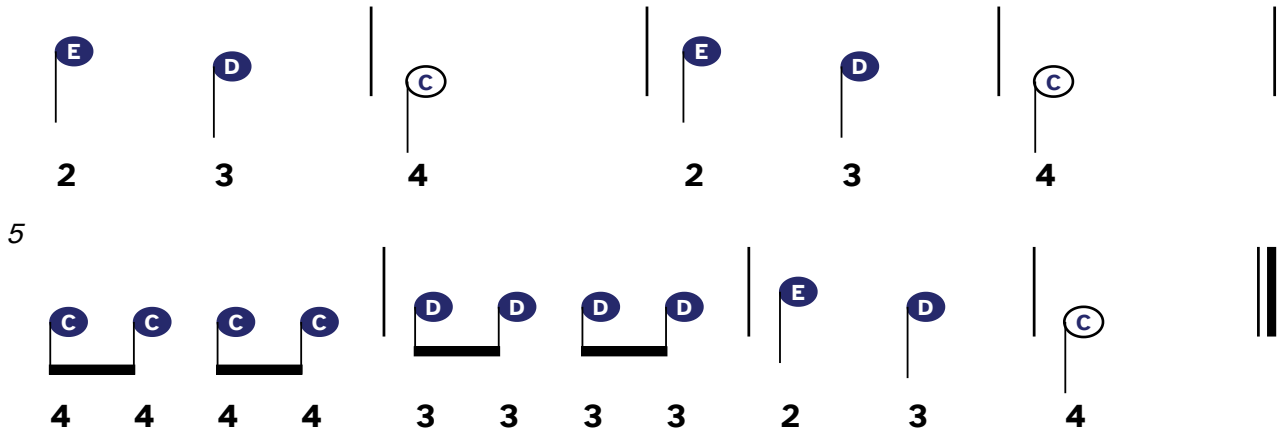
middle C

Right hand: 2 on middle C, 3 on D, 4 on E. **Left hand:** an octave lower, 4 on C, 3 on D, 2 on E.

R RIGHT HAND 4 3 2



L LEFT HAND 2 3 4, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can sing the letter names

I can play it:

☐ Right hand ☐ Left hand

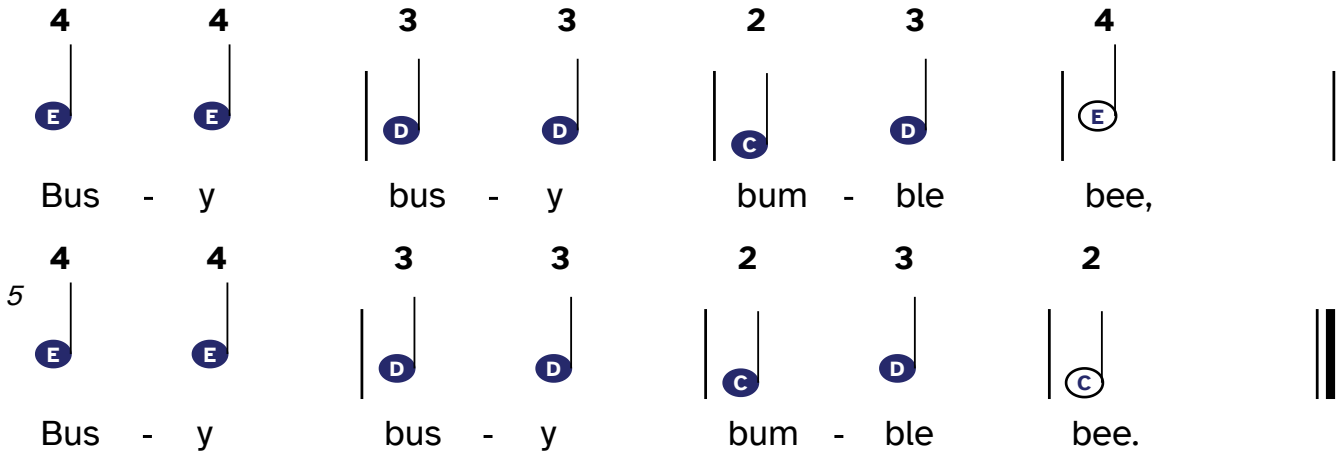
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

The same keys, the same fingers, the same note values: two new tunes. Then make your own.

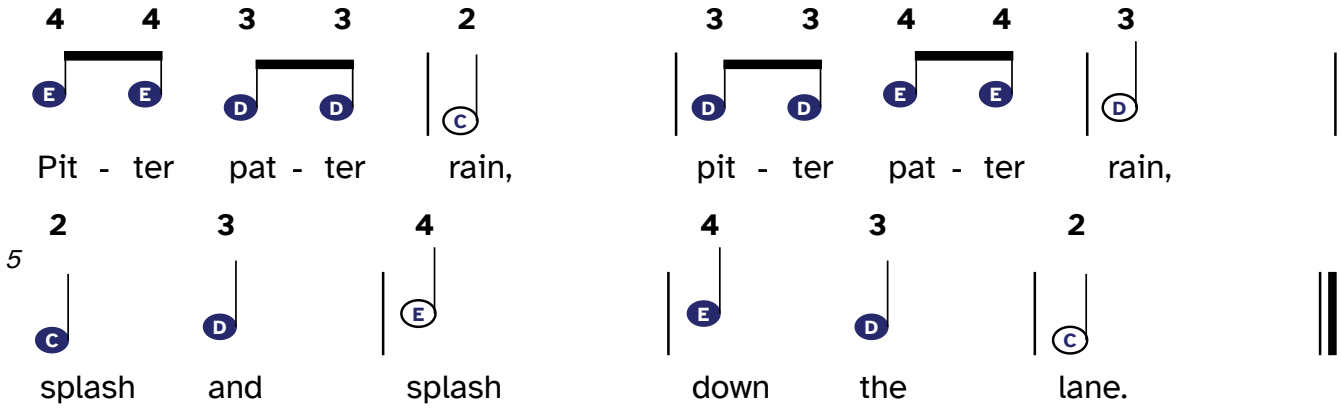
BUSY BEE

Sing it on the words, then play it.



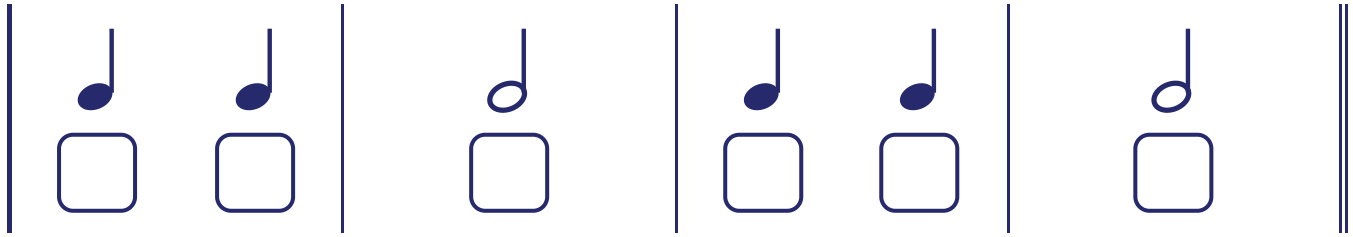
PITTER PATTER

Say the words in rhythm first, then play it.



YOUR OWN TUNE

Write a letter in each box, then play your tune. Give it a name: _____



- [ ] **Played the first tune**
- [ ] **Played the second tune**
- [ ] **Played my own tune**